

Status Quo: DIY (Group Chat + Spreadsheet + Venmo)

Roamly Groups — Target Segment: The Celebration-Trip Organizer

1. KNOW THE LANDSCAPE

COMPETITOR OVERVIEW

Not a company — a default behavior. When a friend group plans a celebration trip, this is what happens automatically before anyone considers a dedicated tool: a group chat for logistics, a shared note or spreadsheet for the itinerary, and Venmo/Zelle requests to split costs. One person's card fronts every real booking.

KEY OFFERINGS

- **Coordination:** WhatsApp/iMessage group thread for decisions and updates
- **Planning:** Shared Google Doc, Notes app, or spreadsheet for the itinerary
- **Payments:** Venmo/Zelle requests sent manually, tracked by memory or a running tally

PRICING

Free. No subscription, no platform fee. Venmo/Zelle take negligible or no cut on personal transfers — the real cost is time and social friction, not money.

2. UNDERSTAND THE BATTLEFIELD

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Zero adoption friction:** no download, no account, apps everyone already has open
- **Total flexibility:** works for any trip shape or size, nothing to configure
- **No new trust required:** friends already trust the organizer, Venmo, and the group chat
- **No CAC to “acquire”:** it's already running before Roamly enters the conversation

KEY WEAKNESSES

- **All labor on one person:** organizer manually tracks payments and confirmations
- **No visibility for the group:** participants can't see what's booked or owed
- **No payment enforcement:** Venmo requests get ignored with no organizer leverage
- **Disconnected from bookings:** itinerary and payment tracker never sync with reality
- **Breaks down at scale:** more people/activities = faster collapse of the whole stack

3. WIN THE DEAL

WHY YOU WIN

Roamly Groups replaces manual labor with automation at the exact moment it's most painful — one link handles the invite, the split payment, and the shared itinerary together, so nothing needs to be re-typed, re-tracked, or re-requested. This scales where DIY doesn't: as group size or trip complexity increases, the DIY stack gets harder to maintain while Roamly Groups doesn't.

WHY THEY WIN

For a simple 3–4 person trip with one or two bookings, DIY is genuinely faster than getting everyone to create a new account — there's no world where “download this app” beats “we already have a group chat” on pure effort for a low-complexity trip.

WHY YOU LOSE

Roamly Groups only wins once coordination pain exceeds a threshold. Below that threshold — small group, simple trip, low stakes — the status quo wins on effort alone, and no amount of positioning changes that math. Target trip complexity and group size as qualifying signals; don't try to win every celebration trip regardless of size.

4. HANDLE THE HARD MOMENTS

QUICK DISMISS

"We're just using a group chat, it's fine."

"Totally fair for a quick trip — worth trying Roamly Groups once the group gets big enough that you're starting to lose track of who's paid and who's confirmed."

LANDMINE QUESTIONS

- **"What happens if someone in the group refuses to pay through Roamly?"** A real edge case — mixed adoption (some paying via the app, one holdout on Venmo) needs a considered answer, not a dismissal.
- **"Isn't this just Splitwise with extra steps?"** Don't get defensive — acknowledge Splitwise/Venmo solve payment-splitting well already. The differentiator is one flow for booking + payment + itinerary, not payment-splitting alone.

OBJECTION	RESPONSE
"It's free, this isn't."	Reframe cost as time and social friction, not money — the organizer is already paying with hours of chasing and awkward reminders.
"My friends won't sign up for a new app."	Guests interact as guests — pay and view the itinerary without creating an account; only the organizer needs to be a real user.
"We've always done it this way."	Don't argue against habit — ask what happened last time someone paid late or the itinerary fell out of sync. Let their own experience make the case.
"This seems like overkill for a weekend trip."	Agree openly for small trips — position Roamly Groups as the upgrade path once the group or the plan gets complicated, not a mandatory first step.